



Frontline Workers | Patient Transporters

“Don’t do it.”

“There’s a reason the pay is good.”

The job
sucks.

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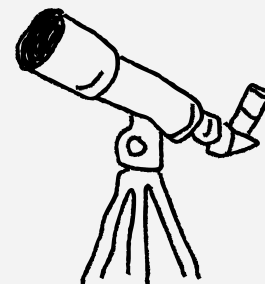
The job sucks.

"I realized real fast that my body will not be able to handle this for 30 years. It's just too much. It's a drain and everything."

Findings

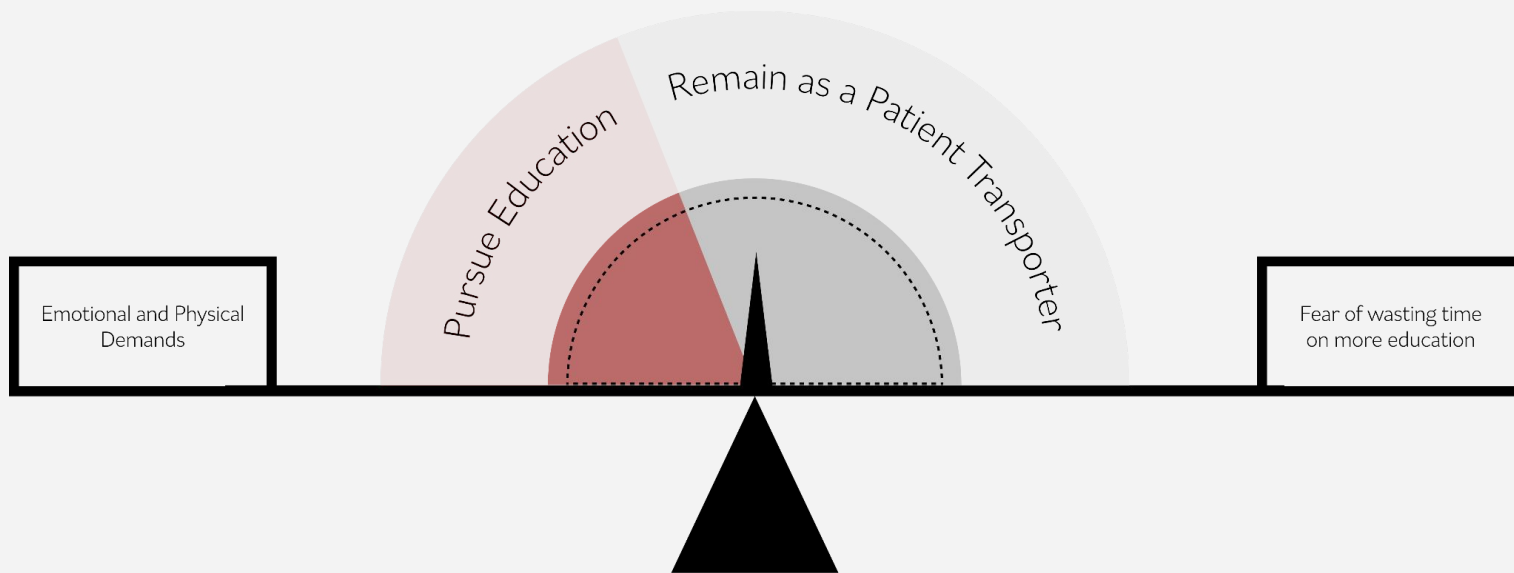


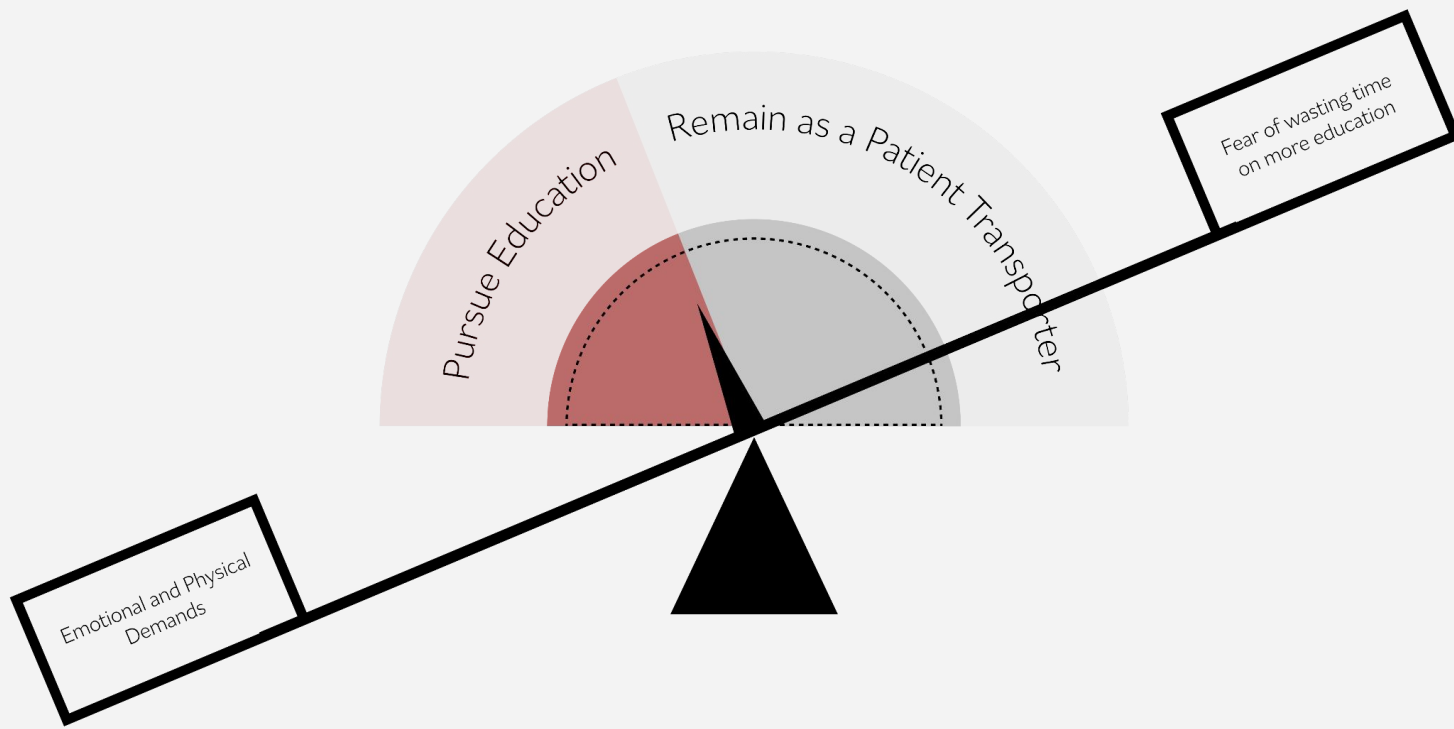
1. While some patient transporters express interest in educational opportunities, they have not done any research to seek them out.
2. When asked to describe the next career they were considering, patient transporters' first comments were typically about the physical and emotional demands of the job.
3. When asked about having advanced education in other fields, patient transporters say things like: "I kind of fucked myself over right there" or "I wish I hadn't gone to college at all."



Insights

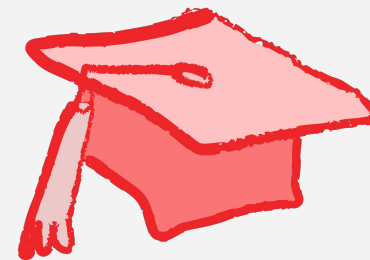
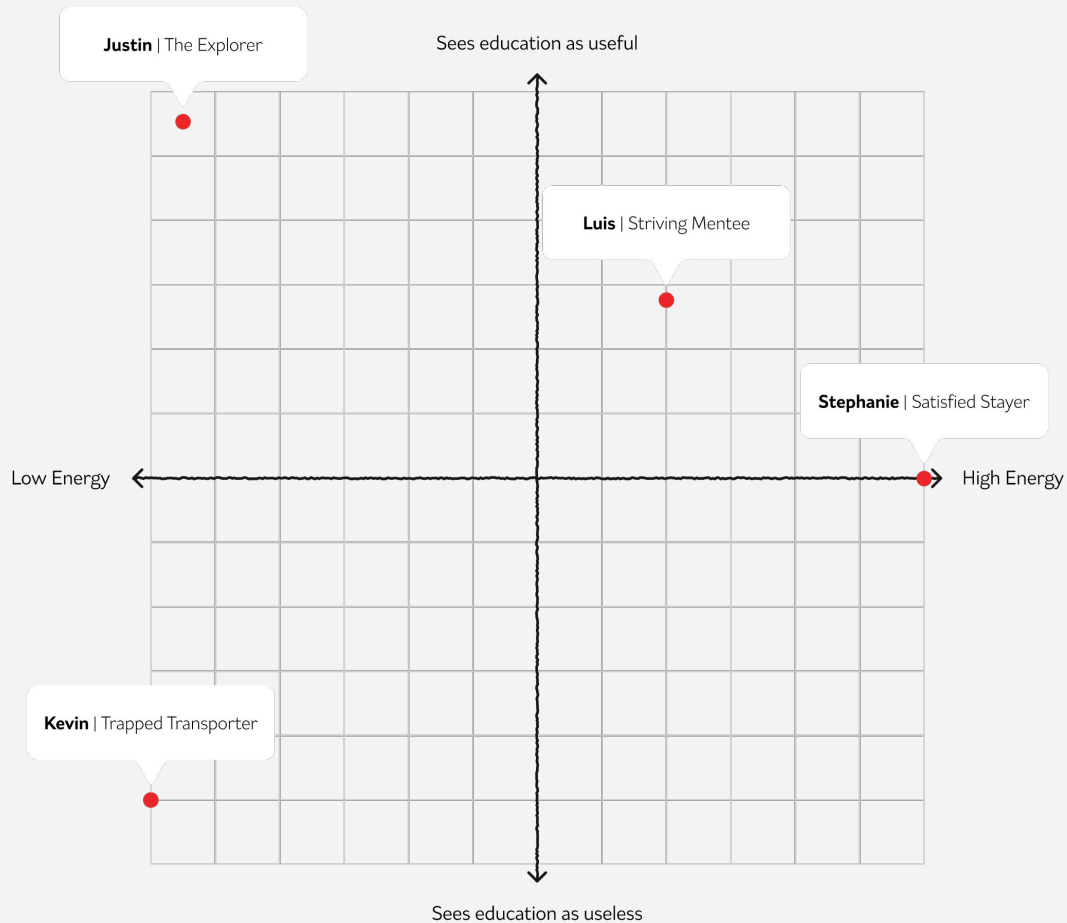
1. For a Patient Transporter to pursue educational opportunities, the emotional and physical demands of their current job must outweigh their fear of wasting time on education.



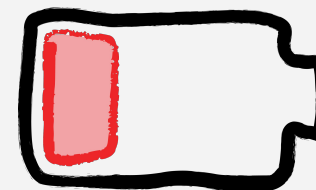


Insights

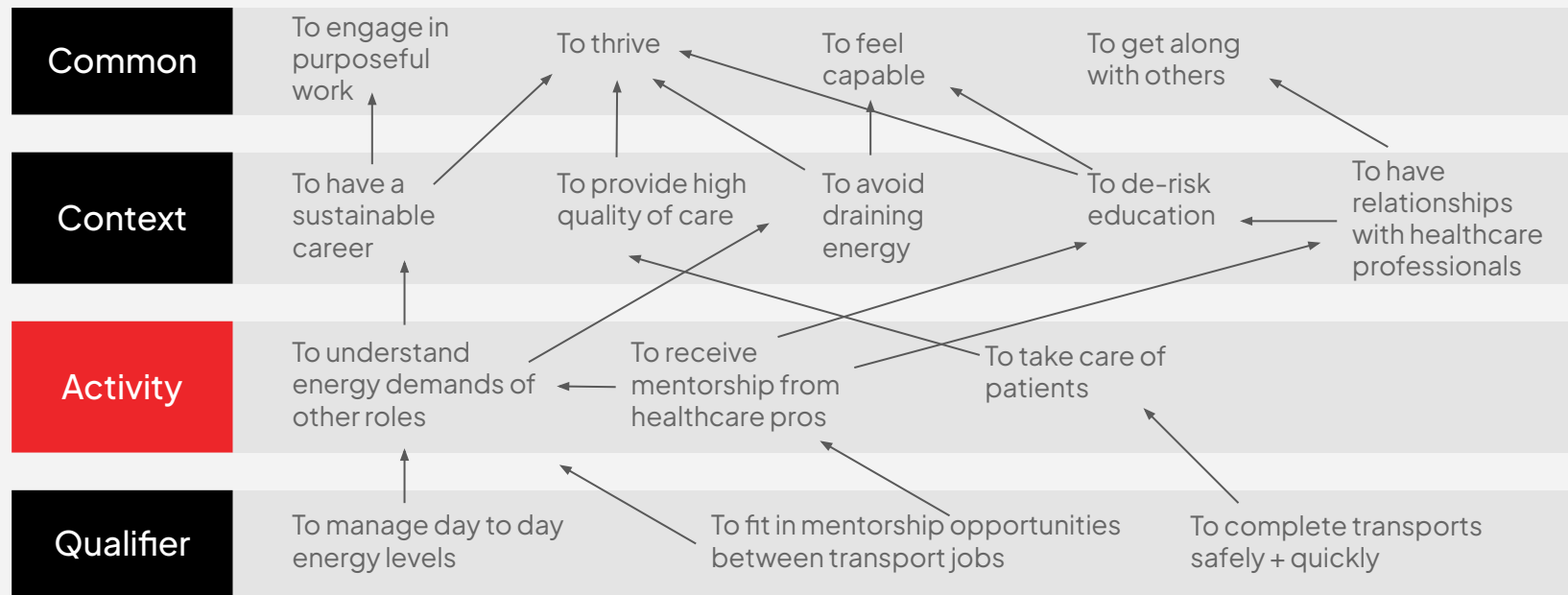
2. In healthcare, energy is everything. Enthusiasm is proof of one's dedication, empathy, and alertness on the job. When a patient transporter feels the negative effects of exhaustion, even temporarily, it's not just a reduction in patient satisfaction, it's their sense of purpose threatened.



Energy vs. Education



Needs of a Patient Transporter



Design Principles

1. Show PTs tiny, low-risk samples of future roles so they feel like they don't have to fully commit to a new career before they're ready to invest their energy into it
2. Make it easy for PTs to meet, shadow, and casually bond with techs and nurses in other departments so they feel like "people like me belong over there too."
3. Provide ways to visualize the difference in physical and emotional load between their role and aspirational roles so they feel like advancement will help them protect their energy.

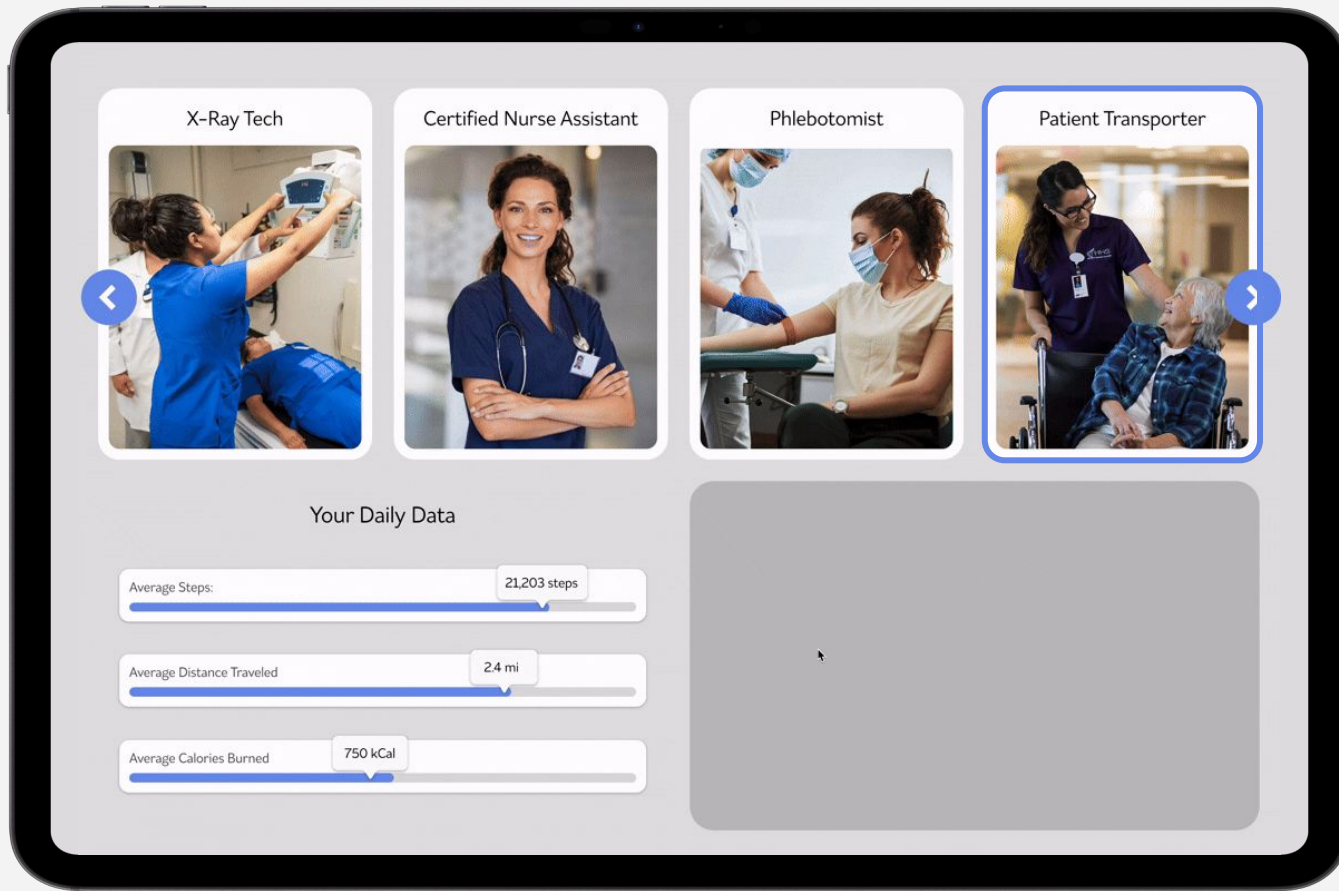
Solutions

StepUp

A dashboard that tracks steps, calories burned, and overall shift activity.

Compares current role with target roles.

Shows how today's effort stacks up against lighter jobs like X-ray or respiratory tech, giving transporters a clear, quantified sense of what moving up could feel like.



Task View + Technician Dispatcher

Preview Roles, Earn Points (**PREP**) Tasks

Patient transporters use natural downtime between transports to complete short ten minute micro shadow tasks in the departments they already move through.

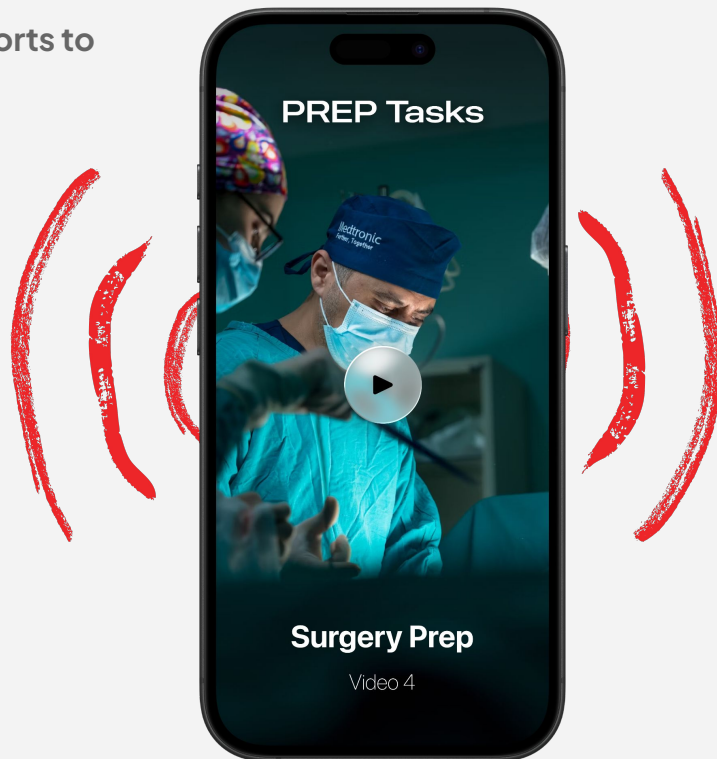
Each department prepares simple low effort tasks:

Imaging: watch a X-ray tech position a patient, observe how a scan is queued, or see how the imaging panel is used

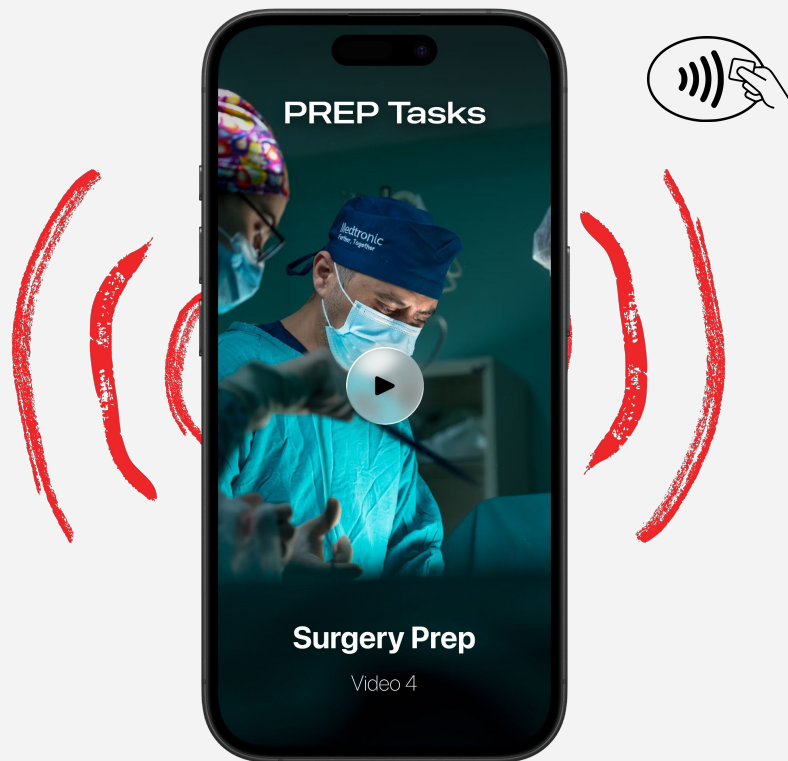
Respiratory: observe a flow meter change or watch a basic oxygen check

ED Tech: observe one vitals check, watch a triage room setup, or see how equipment is staged

Surgery Prep: watch how instruments are laid out or observe the pre op checklist process



Preview Roles, Earn Points (**PREP**) Tasks



For every five logged tasks:

Transporters earn a credit that reduces the cost of a certificate of their choosing

Transporters no longer need to gamble on the risk of not knowing whether the role fits them.

Money allocated towards education is **more likely to be thoughtfully spent**

Explore roles in tiny, energy conscious increments and earn financial support as they go



Thank you!





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